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Implosion to What?

in which all the armaments
of theoretical physics
cannot ward off the conclusion:
implosion produces black holes

The confrontation was inevitable. These two intellectual giants, J. Robert Oppenheimer and John Archibald Wheeler, had such different views of the Universe and of the human condition that time after time they found themselves on opposite sides of deep issues: national security, nuclear weapons policy—and now black holes.

The scene was a lecture hall at the University of Brussels in Belgium. Oppenheimer and Wheeler, neighbors in Princeton, New Jersey, had journeyed there along with thirty-one other leading physicists and astronomers from around the world for a full week of discussions on the structure and evolution of the Universe.

It was Tuesday, 10 June 1958. Wheeler had just finished presenting, to the assembled savants, the results of his recent calculations with Kent Harrison and Masami Wakano—the calculations that had identified, unequivocally, the masses and circumferences of all possible cold, dead stars (Chapter 5). He had filled in the missing gaps in the Chandrasekhar and Oppenheimer–Volkoff calculations, and had confirmed their conclusions: Implosion is compulsory when a star more massive than about 2 Suns dies, and the implosion cannot produce a white dwarf, or a neutron star, or any other kind of cold, dead star, unless the dying star ejects enough mass to pull itself below the maximum-mass limit of about 2 Suns.